menler

CLAUDE-FIRST FELLOWSHIP · WEEK 5

INSTRUCTIONS

Capstone scope & MVP skeleton

Turn a product idea into a real plan and a running skeleton — a scope document Claude can build from, and the first live route of your app, deployed.

Week 5 · Claude Code · CLAUDE.md · MCPs · Lovable / Bolt · Supabase · Replit

Your turning point in the AI era.

W5

Capstone scope & MVP skeleton

Build with AI · The brief

WHAT YOU'LL BUILD

Two things that make the Week 6 capstone buildable. First, a **scope document** — a short, honest plan that says what you are building, for whom, and on what stack. Second, an **MVP skeleton** — the repo scaffolded, Claude wired in, and the **first route running live** on the internet. Not the finished product; the launch pad for it.

- A **product brief** — problem, user, solution and what "done" means.
- A **tech stack** with a one-line justification for each choice.
- A **Claude architecture** — the system prompt, the MCP tools, the Routines.
- A tested **CLAUDE.md** that keeps Claude on-spec while it builds.
- A **scaffolded repo** with the first route deployed and reachable.

WHY IT MATTERS

Most AI projects fail at the blank page, not the hard part. A build Claude can follow starts with a scope tight enough to code against. This week you learn to **think before you build** — and prove it by shipping one real route.

WHERE IT RUNS

Claude Code (or Cursor) for the build, a CLAUDE.md in the repo for context, Supabase for data, and Lovable / Bolt / Replit to deploy the first route.

WHEN TO BUILD & USE IT

Scope early in the week; scaffold mid-week; deploy the first route by the end — so Week 6 is a build sprint, not a scramble.

W5

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How to approach it

THE METHOD

A plan, not a solution. Each step is a decision — the Solution book shows one worked way through, for an app called StudyLoop.

1. **Write the brief first.** One page: the problem, the one user, the solution in a sentence, and what success looks like.
2. **Choose the stack and justify it.** Frontend, backend, database, deploy — one honest line each on why, not just what.
3. **Design the Claude architecture.** What is its system prompt? Which MCP tools does it need? Which Routines run on their own?
4. **Write CLAUDE.md and test it.** Give Claude the file, ask it to summarise the project back, and fix whatever it gets wrong.
5. **Scaffold the repo.** Folders, the first component, the first route — let Claude Code generate it from the CLAUDE.md.
6. **Deploy the first route live** on Replit / Lovable / Bolt and open it on your phone.

REQUIREMENTS

- [ ] A one-page scope document.
- [ ] A justified tech stack.
- [ ] A Claude architecture (prompt + tools + Routines).
- [ ] A tested CLAUDE.md and one live route.

HAND IN

The **scope document**, your **CLAUDE.md**, and a **link to the first deployed route** — plus a one-line note on what the product is and who it is for.

A LITTLE HINT

Scope **small enough to finish**. A todo app that truly works beats an ambitious platform that never runs. You can always add; you can rarely rescue. Pick the one feature that proves the idea and build only that.